

HEAVY MACHINE-GUNS (1911–45)

The heavy machine-guns of the two world wars proved their effectiveness when used against vehicles. Many were made in calibers of a sufficient size to penetrate light armor. These weapons, such as the gas-operated ones seen here, could also be used at long ranges—the Degtyarev DSHK 1938 had a range of about 1¼ miles (2km), for instance. This helped to compromise the massing of enemy troops prior to attacks.



► HOTCHKISS M1914

Date 1914

Origin France

Barrel 31 in (78.7 cm)

Caliber 8 × 50 mm

Weighing over 36kg (80lb), complete with its tripod, the Hotchkiss MLE 1914 (see p. 195) was a massive gas-operated weapon. While it was normal for machine-gun crews to sit or lie behind their weapons, in some instances they had to stand. This variant of the MLE 1914 is equipped with a shoulder brace and a tripod allowing its use from such a position.

